

RAFAEL BELLO LARA

Senior Software Engineer | MSc Applied Informatics | Computer Science Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 15+ years of experience in backend development using Java, Spring Framework, and Spring Boot. Proven track record designing and delivering scalable, production-grade microservices and RESTful APIs for international clients in the banking, financial services, and e-commerce industries. Experienced mentoring junior developers, and driving solution design from requirements through deployment. Strong hands-on expertise with J2EE, Hibernate (ORM), relational databases (PostgreSQL, MySQL, MS SQL Server), Kafka, CI/CD pipelines, Docker, and AWS cloud services. Scrum Foundation certified with client-facing skills across multicultural teams in Cuba, Venezuela, the United States, and Germany. Currently based in Sofia, Bulgaria with travel flexibility.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java (15+ years), J2EE, SQL, Python, C++, PHP, JavaScript, XML, XHTML

Frameworks: Spring Framework, Spring Boot, Spring AOP, Spring Batch, Hibernate (ORM), JPA, JAX-RS, Django, ASP.NET MVC, LangChain4j

Web Services & Protocols: REST, SOAP, JSON, XML, HTTP, OpenAPI / Swagger

Databases (RDBMS): PostgreSQL, MySQL, Microsoft SQL Server, Oracle, SQLite, Neo4j, DynamoDB

Messaging & Streaming: Apache Kafka (consumers & producers)

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (API Gateway, Lambda, DynamoDB, EC2), Docker, Digital Ocean, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitLab CI), Maven, Gradle

Testing: JUnit, Mockito, Integration Testing, Component Testing, TDD

Version Control: Git (GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket), Subversion (SVN)

Tools & Platforms: IntelliJ IDEA, Eclipse, Atlassian (Jira, Confluence), UNIX/Linux, n8n (workflow automation)

Software Engineering: Microservices Architecture, Software Design Patterns, REST API Design, Agile/Scrum, Code Review, Technical Mentoring

Certifications: Scrum Foundation Professional Certificate (SFPC)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer | Raisin GmbH

September 2021 – Present (4+ years) • Sofia, Bulgaria

- Design and develop new microservices of varying complexity using Java, Spring Boot, JPA, and Hibernate within a distributed architecture.
- Define and document REST APIs using OpenAPI/Swagger specifications, ensuring consistency and contract-first development.
- Implement Apache Kafka consumers and producers for event-driven microservice communication.
- Create and maintain microservice databases (schema design, migrations, query optimization) on relational databases.
- Author comprehensive test suites including unit tests (JUnit, Mockito), integration tests, and component tests following TDD practices.
- Contribute to team code reviews, enforce coding standards, and mentor junior and mid-level engineers on best practices.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams in an Agile/Scrum environment, participating in sprint planning and retrospectives.

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Spring AOP, JPA, Hibernate, OpenAPI, Kafka, JSON, REST, Git, GitLab CI/CD, Maven, AWS, Docker, Atlassian (Jira, Confluence), UNIX/Linux

Software Engineer | BOSCH – ProCon

March 2021 – August 2021 (6 months) • Sofia, Bulgaria

- Implemented new REST API endpoints and extended existing services for microservice-based platform.
- Developed Kafka consumers and producers for asynchronous inter-service communication.

- Created and updated microservice database schemas to support evolving business requirements.
- Wrote unit (JUnit, Mockito), integration, and component tests ensuring high code coverage and quality.
- Actively participated in team code reviews and contributed to technical documentation.

Technologies: *Java, Spring Boot, Spring AOP, JPA, Hibernate, JSON, REST, Git, Bitbucket, Maven, AWS, Docker, Kafka, Atlassian*

Architect / Backend Developer | Curu Inc.

January 2018 – March 2021 (3+ years) • Charlotte, NC, USA (Remote)

- Designed and developed a RESTful API (Java, Spring Boot, JAX-RS) to help users manage personal credit through notifications and behavioral analytics.
- Integrated with third-party financial platforms (Even Financial, Yodlee) for personalized financial offers and data synchronization.
- Applied AI and machine learning techniques (K-Means clustering, association rules, multi-criteria decision making) for credit behavior analysis.
- Architected and implemented an intelligent notification system advising users on credit management based on financial activity patterns.
- Built automated data synchronization processes handling timezone-aware scheduling for user financial information.
- Designed data models to support multi-provider financial information integration (PostgreSQL, DynamoDB).
- Developed serverless microservices on AWS (API Gateway, Lambda, DynamoDB) alongside traditional Spring Boot services.
- Created CI/CD pipelines for automated deployment from Bitbucket to Digital Ocean and AWS.
- Led solution design and technical decision-making as the principal architect on the project.

Technologies: *Java, Spring Boot, JAX-RS, SOAP, REST, JSON, JPA, Hibernate, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, AWS (Lambda, API Gateway), Docker, Git, Bitbucket, Maven, Digital Ocean, CI/CD, Atlassian*

Senior Software Developer | Conoce Cuba

September 2015 – December 2017 (2+ years) • Havana, Cuba

- Developed the Conoce Cuba application for the Windows platform, a geospatial tourism guide with map-based points of interest.
- Engineered data storage pipelines for exporting and processing datasets to SQLite databases consumed by multiple client applications.
- Managed geospatial information systems for location services and map rendering.

Technologies: *C++, Qt, SQLite, Git, UNIX/Linux*

Software Developer | Academia Virtual de Ciencias

2015 – 2017 • Havana, Cuba

- Developed full-stack web application for an online science academy, handling data model design, media synchronization, and web hosting administration.

Technologies: *PHP, MySQL, jQuery, HTML, JavaScript*

Software Developer - Architect | National Bank of Cuba – University of Informatics Sciences

October 2014 – July 2015 • Havana, Cuba

- Led the technology transfer process of the Quarxo Banking System to the National Bank of Cuba, managing end-to-end delivery.
- Planned and delivered Java technology training and business process knowledge to banking operations teams.
- Updated the SWIFT messaging subsystem to comply with evolving international standards.
- Provided real-time production support for core banking subsystems: Letters of Credit, Negotiations & Payments, SWIFT Messaging, Accounting Open/Close.
- Reviewed and maintained system and user documentation for compliance and operational continuity.

Technologies: *Java, Spring, JPA, Hibernate, JSON, Jasper Reports, MS SQL Server, SVN*

Software Developer | Quarxo Banking System – University of Informatics Sciences

2011 – 2014 (3 years) • Havana, Cuba

- Developed the Letter of Credit subsystem and Transactions component for the national banking automation platform.
- Promoted to Chief Architect based on technical leadership and delivery quality.
- Led certification processes with external auditing firms (Segurmática, CONAS S.A.).

Technologies: *Java, Spring, JPA, Hibernate, JSON, Jasper Reports, MS SQL Server, SVN*

Software Developer | **Export and Commerce Bank C.A. (SABIC System)**

2010 – 2011 • Caracas, Venezuela

- Adapted banking automation system (SABIC) to Venezuelan regulatory and financial standards.
- Implemented the Trust Process module and integrated accounting processes with automated check issuance and printing.
- Optimized daily Accounting Start and Close processes for improved system performance.
- Provided daily production support for banking operations.

Technologies: *Visual FoxPro, MS SQL Server*

EDUCATION

Master of Science: Applied Informatics

University of Informatics Sciences, Havana | 2012 – 2014

Computer Science Engineer – *Graduated with Honours*

University of Informatics Sciences, Havana | 2005 – 2010

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Published researcher in Artificial Intelligence and Applied Computing with results in internationally recognized scientific journals:

- Compensatory Fuzzy Logic for Intelligent Social Network Analysis
- Model for Static Analysis in Fuzzy Graphs Based on Composite Centrality Indicators
- Static Analysis of Scientific Collaboration Networks (Cuban Journal of Computer Science)
- Technique for Static Network Analysis Based on Fuzzy Logic and Aggregation Operators

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native | **English:** Intermediate (Professional Working Proficiency)